New Directions for ESDS Qualidata: 2003 and beyond

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IASSIST 2003

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University of Essex

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ESDS Qualidata

- Specialist function of the new UK Economic and Social Data Service (ESDS)
- Hosted by the UK Data Archive
- Will provide access to, and support for, a range of qualitative datasets
- The work builds on Qualidata's expertise and international reputation in this area, developed over the past eight years

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- To provide the development and maintenance of a more integrated approach to the archiving and dissemination of social and economic data
- To provide more seamless and easier access to a range of disparate resources for the educational sectors
- Services:
  - Management and Co-ordination Service
  - Core Data Archiving and Preservation Service
  - Government Data Service
  - International Data Service
  - Qualitative Data Service
  - Longitudinal Data Service

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Qualidata: old remit

- UK national service for acquisition, dissemination and re-use of social science qualitative research data
- Used network of UK archives for deposit
- Worked closely with the UK Research Council (ESRC) to operate its Datasets Policy
- Outreach activities and support for creating and depositing data, resource discovery

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ESDS Qualidata: new remit

- Ensure that key data source are adequately supported and opportunities are provided to add value to them:
  - Data acquisition & liaison with data suppliers and depositors
  - Data enhancement
  - Value-added data delivery
  - On-line data provision
  - Specialist advice
  - Specialist user group and training activities

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Types of qualitative data

- Diverse data types: in-depth interviews ; semi-structured interviews; focus groups; oral histories; open-ended survey questions; case notes/records of meetings; diaries/ research diaries
- Multi-media: audio, video, photos and text (typically transcriptions)
- Formats: digital, paper, analogue audio-visual
- Data structures - differ across different 'document types'
- Scope for re-use across different disciplines

Collections

- Data from National Research Council (ESRC) individual research grant awards
- Data from ESRC Programme research grant awards
- Data from ‘classic’ social science studies
- Other funders/sources

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Assessing strategies and priorities

- User survey 2000
- ESRC ‘Green paper’ exercise - UK resource provision for social science data… and recent tender
- ESDS User consultation April 2003 - web survey to determine priorities for data ‘enhancements’ and support & training resources
  - results on web June

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Kinds of data used

- 4 in 10 (N=70) had undertaken secondary analysis of qualitative data (SAQD)
  - Textual data consulted far more than audio-visual
  - in-depth interviews and semi-structured interviews consulted most
  - case study notes and interview summaries and press clippings also used
- 70% thought they might use sources of qualitative data in future research
- Few existing databanks mentioned
  - Qualidata; CHILDES; TALKBANK databases

Researchers' use of data

- Sources consulted:
  - revisited their own data (70%)
  - using colleague's data (44%)
  - acquiring archived data via a dissemination service (33%)

- Uses:
  - descriptive purposes (50%)
  - comparative research, a restudy or a follow-up study (50%).
  - secondary analysis (40%)
  - research design/methodological advancement (40%)
  - teaching and learning (40%)
  - verification of original analyses (22%)

Use of CAQDAS packages

- Under half (44%) used a CAQDAS packages on a regular basis
  - NVivo (11%)
  - ATLAS-ti (11%),
  - N4-6/NUD*IST (10%)
  - WinMAX/MaxQDA (8%)
  - Qualrus (3%)

  - Other softwares mentioned: answr; CLAN, TASX, Mineset, SPSS and Excel.

- 4 out of 10 respondents said that they would expect to use a CAQDAS package to re-analyse qualitative data

Difficulties experienced when accessing and using qualitative data

Generally found to be difficult to obtain or access relevant material:

Accessing data	***%***
Locating appropriate data	87
Format of data e.g. paper	67
Archival organisation of data	62
Access conditions	62

Using data	
Time to consult sources	80
Adequate data/project documentation	68
Re-analysing qualitative data	33

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What resources could help?

- Thematic guides and data samples (96%)
- Online access to data held (96%)

  "samples of data on-line to aid selection of data sets for secondary study would be beneficial"

  "the ability to access electronic and/or hard copies of e.g. transcripts away from archives and re-code/analyse using preferred software/manual methods"
- Coded data, in addition to raw data, from the original research (90%)
- Ability to explore data or conduct new basic thematic analysis online (94%)

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Resource themes desired

• family and social networks	54
• social class, work and employment	51
• life stories and social change	49
• youth culture	36
• crime and social order	26
• mental health and institutionalisation	19

- UK classic community studies
- International data sources

Helped ESDS Qualidata to set priorities

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Training requirements

- Online training and support resources (e.g. course materials and 'how to' guides)
- Theme based courses drawing on a range of data
- Courses to raise awareness of the datasets and their research potential
- Courses on specific aspects of particular datasets, or kinds of data:
  - data confrontation and data handling skills
  - thematic data analysis; 'grounded theory' data analysis
  - oral history methods
  - conversation analysis
  - CAQDAS

Enhanced user guides and digital samplers

To provide a better understanding of the study and research methods

- Digital samplers of classic sociology collections
- Enhanced users guides – detailed notes on study methodology and re-use; 'Behind the scenes' interviews with depositors; FAQs
- Thematic web pages
- Tailored training datasets

Exemplars and case studies of re-use

To provide guidance on data resources and how to re-use them

- Overview of ways of re-using data
- Case studies and bibliographies of re-use including reflections and commentary
- Online training resources - simple
- User support and training programme

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On-line access to qualitative data

- New emphasis on providing direct access to collection content
  - ✓ Supports more powerful resource discovery
  - ✓ Greater scope for searching and browsing content of data (supplementary to higher level study-related metadata)
- Providing access to qualitative data via common interface (Edwardians Online)
- Supporting tools for searching, retrieval, analysis across different datasets

Exploring qualitative data on-line

- More than file download
- Access to content and structure
  - Speaker tags
  - Coded textual
  - Links to contextual documentation
    - Audio files; fieldnotes; photos; analytical annotations etc
  - Links to other sources
    - Micro data; aggregate statistics; maps; census data etc.

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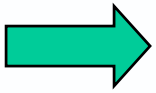
Why preserve thematic content coding?

- Preserving researcher's analytic products (coded data) preserves record of primary interpretation of dataset, promotes openness in research
  - replication; confirmation; re-interpretation.
- Useful as retrieval aids for voluminous bodies of text
- User familiarity – CAQDAS information retrieval and management
- Limitations to using original researcher's coding:
  - individual coder's interpretation
  - not a complete representation of full thematic content

Towards a Standard Format for Qualitative Data Resources

- Data needs to be preserved in a uniform resource format
  - Easier for provider (maintenance, tools, interchange)
  - Easier for user (consistency across data sets)
- DDI provides an XML framework for survey content (variables) but currently no suitable standard format for the content of qualitative data
- Need a comprehensive application appropriate for interchange that will enable sophisticated on-line searching and information retrieval from encoded texts



The Edwardians Online Pilot

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XML and Standard Archive Formats

- Research into a general DTD for describing qualitative datasets using existing standards
- TEI guidelines for transcriptions of speech provide basis for markup of dialogue content (interview structure)
- DDI framework provides basis for bibliographic information, such as the study and file description header.
- Overlap between the two DTDs – use selection from both -eg TEI for content and electronic file creation

Stand-off Architecture in XML

- Challenges for developing an XML application included the multiple hierarchies in the transcript texts and overlapping fields or elements:

  dialogue structure v thematic content

- Conventional markup of these structures in a single document violates nesting rules of XML
- Solution - 'stand-off annotation' approach whereby data and coding stored in different documents
- Proven utility as method for annotating multi-coded dialogue corpora. Allows for:
  - allows for multiple coding schemes
  - accomodates overlapping elements
  - easily extendable

Basic search and retrieve functionality

- Developed online querying function based on annotation of texts and themes in XML
- Users can select theme from index list and retrieve extracts of text in particular documents coded by that theme
- Can jump from extract to view in full document context and navigate between extracts in a theme

Nesstar Light VERSION 2.0 beta

SUPPORT
- Systematic Analysis of Life Histories,
  - Study Description
    - Bibliographic Citation
    - Study Scope
    - Methodology And Processing
    - Data Access
    - Other Study Description Material
  - Variable Description
    - Background information
    - Household information/values
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Add Remove

Selected Variables:

PARENTAL VALUES
FATHERS OCCUPATIONAL STATUS IN

Tabulate Run Analysis

Description | Table | Graph | Weight | Subset | Download | Help

Dataset: Systematic Analysis of Life Histories, 1870-1918

Variable IOCST911 : INFORMANTS OCCUPATIONAL STATUS IN 1911

Value	Categories	N	
0	PROFES SIONAL	7	3.5%
1	MANA GERIAL	7	3.5%
2	CLERICAL	9	4.5%
3	MANUAL SUPERVISE	3	1.5%
4	SKILLED	66	33.0%
5	SEMI SKILLED	91	45.5%
6	UN SKILLED	16	8.0%
7	NOT EMPLOYED	1	0.5%
8	ABSENT DEAD ETC	0	0.0%
9	DONTKNOWNOT APP	244	

Summary statistics

Valid cases 200

This variable is numeric

Total Responses

Summation of listed categories: 444

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Reporting bugs : www.nsd.uib.no/nesstar

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Selected Variables:

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Tabulate Run Analysis

Description | Table | Graph | Weight | Subset | Download | Help

Dataset: Systematic Analysis of Life Histories, 1870-1918

Variable FOCST911 : FATHERS OCCUPATIONAL STATUS IN 1911

Value	Categories	N	
0	PROFES SIONAL	10	4.7%
1	MANA GERIAL	45	21.2%
2	CLERICAL	7	3.3%
3	MANUAL SUPERVISE	8	3.8%
4	SKILLED	64	30.2%
5	SEMI SKILLED	56	26.4%
6	UN SKILLED	22	10.4%
7	NOT EMPLOYED	0	0.0%
8	ABSENT DEAD ETC	0	0.0%
9	DONTKNOWNOT APP	232	

Summary statistics

Valid cases 212

This variable is numeric

Total Responses

Summation of listed categories: 444

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Bibliographic Citation
Study Scope
Methodology And Processing
Data Access
Other Study Description Materials
Variable Description
Background information
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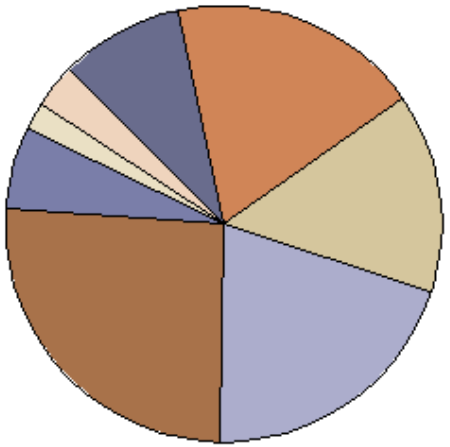
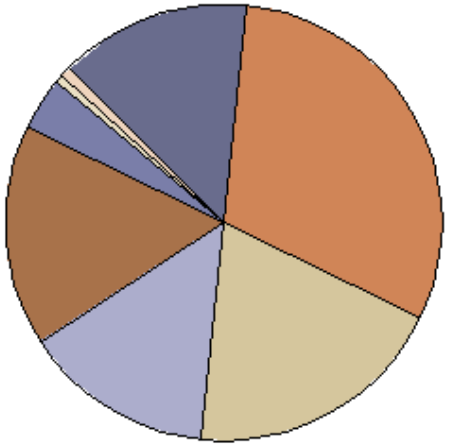
Tabulate Run Analysis

TYPE OF PUNISHMENT BY INFORMANTS SEX



MALE



FEMALE

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Phase II and beyond

- Evaluate prototype functionality and usability
- Define model and a DTD based on DDI with a data content element
  - Enable preservation/portable format for coded qualitative data (import/export from CAQDAS packages)
- Develop tools sets for publishing and querying data
- Enable simultaneous manipulation and display of quantitative data, e.g. via the NESSTAR system